



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Albuquerque

School Website: <https://www.chestertonabq.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Albuquerque (ABQ) presents a coherent classical Catholic model of education. Public materials on their site emphasize a liberal-arts oriented, faith-informed curriculum, with explicit focus on formation (virtue, wisdom, and beauty), the integration of theology with the humanities, and a classical cadence across history, literature, philosophy, and the arts. The school foregrounds Catholic identity (daily Mass, theology texts, liturgical life) and anchors its pedagogy in a three-pillar framework (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) that centers on formation through a culture of life. Evidence of a robust curriculum (two years of Latin, four-year history sequence, and an integrated classical approach) and a faculty described in terms of mentors and living exemplars further supports a CLASSICAL rating across most categories. The primary area with comparatively weaker explicit public signals of classical pedagogy is the explicit mention of Socratic seminars or similar high-school seminar formats; nonetheless, the explicit emphasis on classical inquiry, Great Books-style formation, and the liberal-arts curriculum keeps Element 4 in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range rather than NOT CLASSICAL or fully CLASSICAL.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- Evidence across categories shows a consistent classical Catholic orientation: daily Mass and theology as central, formation-focused aims, a structured liberal-arts curriculum, Latin study, a four-year history sequence, and a faculty described in terms of virtue and mentorship.
- Key public signals include: Catholic theology and liturgy (Bible, Catechism, Mass, liturgy), the Three Pillars and Cultura Vitae, a classical curriculum with Latin and history across grades, integrated humanities (literature/history/philosophy/theology), and a parent-led/community orientation (volunteer culture, founding/parent-led model). Citations illustrate these signals: daily Mass and Catholic theology (Mass daily); three-pillar model and Cultura Vitae; integrated classical curriculum and Latin requirements; explicit humanities and theology focus; and parent-led/volunteer community language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Catholic identity is explicit; theology and liturgical life are central; daily Mass described; Bible/Catechism taught as core texts; Cultura Vitae motto and Three Pillars affirm a sacred, metaphysical orientation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Catholic, Theology, Bible, Catechism, Mass, Liturgy, Sacred, Virtue, Cultivation of Wisdom, and Sacred Tradition. No notable negative signals detected in public materials. (Cross-reference: Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword lists.)
- Why this rating: The school's public materials place religion, theology, liturgical life, and metaphysical aims at the center of education, aligning with transcendental moral realism and a metaphysical frame. CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on formation over information; cultivation of virtue and human excellence; pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real; three-pillar formation; liberal-arts focus; Cultura Vitae.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, liberal education, telos, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, great conversation, moral imagination, and holistic formation. No strong signals of career- or job-prep emphasis in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The stated aims foreground virtue, wisdom, and aesthetic/ethical formation rather than vocational instrumentalism, matching Classical ideals. CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials describe an integrated classical curriculum, with a liberal-arts orientation; history studied across the curriculum; four-year history sequence; Latin required for two years; arts and philosophy integrated in humanities; art/music/drama as explicit components.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/Primary sources, Latin, history, integration across disciplines, and wonder. Public materials explicitly show Latin instruction and a four-year history sequence; Great Books are implied through “classics of Western thought” and integrated humanities. Negative signals (e.g., purely social-studies framing) are not evident.
- Why this rating: The curriculum signals align strongly with classical education expectations (liberal arts/grammar/logic/rhetoric spectrum, Latin, history across the curriculum, and Great Books-style formation implied through “classics” and “Western thought”). CLASSICAL.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public posts emphasize a three-pillars framework and a classical approach to thinking; but explicit signals of high-school-level Socratic seminars or seminars/debates as standard pedagogy are not clearly explicit in the public materials. The presence of a classical curriculum and “how to think” emphasis implies some Socratic/dialogue-based pedagogy, but direct statements about seminars or student-led Socratic discourse are not clearly stated on the site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, seminar, or debates (as per the Six Essentials lexicon), but public materials do not consistently show these as formal practices; instead they emphasize “teaching students not merely what to think but how to think” and the Three Pillars. Negative signals are not explicitly evident, but the absence of explicit, explicit high-school Socratic pedagogy keeps this category from full CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The site signals a classical approach, but lacks explicit and regular mention of upper-school Socratic seminars, logic-based discourse, or high-profile rhetoric training in a manner clearly documented on public pages. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials show named faculty (Headmaster, Mathematics, Drama, History/Latin/Spanish, etc.) with language that describes teachers as engaged professionals in a Catholic, classical frame; there is emphasis on faculty as mentors and living curriculum, and the Headmaster’s theology and classical background are highlighted.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtuous educators, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, and moral exemplars. The site’s faculty pages convey mentorship and formation, aligning with classical faculty ideals. No explicit negative signals identified.
- Why this rating: The public materials portray a faculty model consistent with classical education values—teachers as mentors and exemplars embedded in a Catholic, classical milieu. CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site emphasizes a parent-founded and led model, volunteer involvement, and partnerships with families; public sections invite parent participation, tours, and community activities; the “Volunteer” page explicitly frames Chesterton ABQ as parent-led, with parents as co-educators in the Ecclesia Domestica frame.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, volunteer, home-school alignment, and parental leadership. There are explicit signals of parent involvement and community partnerships. Negative signals are not evident in public materials.
- Why this rating: The school clearly presents a robust and active parent/community orientation consistent with classic aims of communal formation and parental partnership in classical education. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- All six categories largely align with a classical model, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing the most conservative signal (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) due to the absence of explicit, recurring statements about Socratic seminars or other named classical pedagogy in the public pages. The aggregate rating thus stands as CLASSICAL.
- Abstract keyword anchors from the Six Essential Elements and related lexicon (positive signals like truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Great Books/primary texts; Latin; formation; wonder; virtue; shared mission with families) are evident in the Chesterton ABQ materials. The school's public outputs consistently map onto the classical lexicon: Catholic theology and liturgy, formation-focused aims, liberal-arts curriculum with Latin and history, a faculty anchored in mentorship, and a supportive parent/community network. See the cited passages for theology, liturgy, culture-of-life motto, Latin, history sequence, and faculty/parent roles.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a SCHOOL-wide move toward FULLY CLASSICAL (if needed in the future), publicly emphasize explicit Socratic/seminal pedagogy signals (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, classical rhetoric training, and memory-work signals) in public-facing materials. This would strengthen Element 4 to CLASSICAL.
- Maintain and highlight explicit signals of the liberal-arts framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis, Great Books language, and the Quadrivium) in site copy to reinforce Element 3's full Classical alignment.
- Continue to foreground liturgical and communal practices (Mass, daily theology integration) to sustain Element 1's signals of transcendental moral realism and liturgical life.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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